

birth bag checklist

For you:

- Your notes
- Your birth plans
- Your phone or camera whatever you wanna take pics on
- Your relaxation MP3s where your birth partner can find them
- Headphones for staying in your bubble
- Relaxing or uplifting music on a playlist
- Affirmations to put around the room
- TENS machine
- Some battery operated fairy lights and candles
- Relaxing scents that you've used to anchor during relaxation
- Flannel and fan for keeping cool
- Whatever snacks and drinks you might fancy
- A nice pillow so that you're not stuck with hospital ones
- Hair clips and bands to keep your hair out of your face
- A birth ball just in case all the ones there are in use
- Straw so that you can drink comfortably
- Distraction/something funny to watch or listen to
- An eye mask to get in a little private bubble
- Comfy clothes for during and after birth
- Lots of underwear in case they get messy after birth, big comfy ones!
- Maternity pads- big ones!
- Lip balm
- Nipple cream
- Breast pads
- Clothes, phone charger, underwear etc for birth partner in case you're there for a while
- Toiletries for having a wash after birth
- Change in case that's how you have to pay for parking or for vending machines
- Some slippers or flip flops for walking around your birth place



birth bag checklist

For baby:

- Clothing – pack three or four babygrows , vests and sleepsuits for your little one to wear.
- Going home outfit – quite a few parents have a special going home outfit that they plan to bring their baby home in.
- Scratch mits – these will help prevent your little one from scratching their face with their sharp nails (or suits with mitts included)
- Hat – for when you go outside
- Swaddles – the big wide world is a strange place for your newborn, so give them a sense of security with a swaddle which helps to replicate the feeling of the womb.
- Baby blanket – this will help keep them warm, especially when leaving the hospital.
- Nappies (reusable?) – your newborn will go through a lot of nappies, as many as 12 a day. We always recommend reusable nappies. They help save the planet, your pennies and they're kinder to delicate skin.
- Muslin squares – to mop up any spills or messes easily.
- wipes/cotton wool
- Socks
- Formula/milk if your choice of feeding
- Cord tie



homebirth checklist

- Your maternity notes.
- Your birth plans.
- Blankets and towels (lots) to keep you and the baby warm and dry after you give birth. (Extra if you're using a pool and may get in and out.)\
- Plastic sheets for under the pool and on the sofas/bed.
- Bin bags for rubbish and laundry.
- Bowl or bucket for if you're sick.
- Food and drink for you and your birth partner.
- Comfort and relaxation tools such as electric tea lights/candles, hot water bottle, massage oil, flannels for hot or cold compresses.
- MP3's/Birthy playlist.
- Birth ball.
- Aromatherapy & diffuser (lavender/clary sage are top favourites)
- Cord tie, if you plan to use one.
- Whatever you want to wear in labour, which might include a big t-shirt, a bikini top, hair ties, or nothing at all.
- Maternity pads.
- TENS machine, if you want one (some trusts do provide them so ask your midwife).
- Incontinence pads.
- Baby clothes/nappies.
- Hospital bag in case of transfer.
- Somewhere for the midwife to put their birth kit/set up.
- Affirmation cards.
- Birth comb.

If planning a Pool Birth:

- Pool liner
- Medical grade hose
- Sieve
- Plastic sheets
- Tap adapters
- Pump
- Water pump
- Thermometer
- Mirror



*Depending on where you source your pool from some items may be included.



newborn checklist

- Crib (look for British Standard mark BS EN 716-1 to make sure it complies with UK safety standards)
- Cot mattress
- Bedding (3-4 mattress covers)
- Muslin cloths (lots!)
- 4-8 Sleepsuits (zip ones are great) mixed sizes (Newborn/First size etc)
- 4-8 vests
- 1-3 newborn hats
- No-scratch mittens (optional)
- 2-3 swaddles
- Lightweight and heavy blankets
- 2-3 large boxes of disposable newborn-size nappies, or 6-10 dozen cloth nappies and 6-8 nappies covers
- Box of water baby wipes
- Cotton wool pads/reusable wipes
- Baby bathtub
- Baby shampoo and body wash (won't need for a couple weeks)
- 2-4 hooded baby towels
- 4-6 Soft washcloths
- 8-10 bottles and teats (4oz is fine and first size teats)
- Bottle brush
- Dishwasher basket for small items/bottle storage/drying
- Formula (if not breastfeeding)
- Breast pump (if you plan to breastfeed- wait until established)
- Milk storage bags (if you plan to breastfeed-wait until established)
- Nursing pads (if you plan to breastfeed-wait until established)
- Nipple cream (if you plan to breastfeed-wait until established)
- Baby feeding pillow (optional)
- Bottle sterilizer (optional)
- Baby nail clippers or file
- Baby thermometer
- Petroleum jelly or coconut oil
- First aid kit
- Soft brush
- 4-6 dummies (optional)
- Car seat
- Pram
- Baby sling
- White noise app



short relaxations/prompts

It is important to practise the relaxations in pregnancy and listen to the audio. They can also be very calming in early labour. But in established labour the surges will be too close together to have time to do a relaxation in between, although it can still be helpful to have the audio playing in the background.

You can use the triggers from the scripts you have practised to help you relax quickly in advanced labour. Here are some suggestions:

A gentle, deep breath

- Just one lovely, gentle, deep breath. As you let the air flow out in the long, relaxed outbreath, your body is producing oxytocin and endorphins. Notice as you breathe in that the air is cool and as you breathe out the air is warmer. You've fucking got this.

Relax

- The word 'Relax' takes them back to the confidence, calm and comfort above the soft clouds. This image is very powerful.

Stroking

- Stroking on any part of the body that is convenient. If available the forehead and the space between the eyebrows can be especially relaxing.

Safe place

- Remind her to bring to mind her special place where she feels happy and at ease.

Drop your shoulders

- You will be amazed how much tension suddenly falls away that you didn't know was there when you allow your shoulders to drop.

Partner's voice – think back to the partner relaxation.

Soft mouth

- Look for tension in the jaw, make sure her mouth and jaw are relaxed – stroking, kissing. Floppy Face- Floppy Fanny!

Back stroking

- The back stroking.massage on the video on YouTube.



birth pool inflation guide

- Here are the basic steps to take when inflating your birth pool.
- Firstly, remove the pool from packing and warm to room temperature for 72 hours before inflation
- Using the electric air pump provided, select the smallest valve adapter
- Inflate the floor first
- Unscrew cap on side valve (top one). Select the appropriate valve adapter on the electric air pump, start inflating at the bottom ring
- As soon as the pool ring is firm, stop the electric pump and replace side valve cover
- Repeat this process for both bottom and middle valve
- When inflating the top ring, leave it slightly deflated to allow the liner to be put on
- Inflate the seat
- Put on pool liner
- After the liner is in place, inflate the top ring fully and when the pool is firm, screw on the side valve cap.
- Fill the pool with warm water
- That's it you're all ready to go!

